

FEMINIST STUDIES

Notable Faculty & Student Achievements

November 2025

Assistant Professor of Feminist Studies **Meagan Solomon** attended the 2025 National Women's Studies Association (NWSA) Conference in San Juan, Puerto Rico (Borikén) from November 13–16. She presented on a roundtable titled "Archiving Malflora: Latina/e Lesbian Memory Work as Decolonial Praxis," along with four other members of Malflora Collective, her collaborative PEH project focused on preserving Latina/e lesbian histories. The roundtable focused on creative strategies for archiving community stories through zine-making, podcasting, and digital archival practices, while also contending with the fraught nature of online platforms.

Professor of Anthropology **Melissa Johnson** and her Summer 2025 SURF students presented their findings at the 13th Race, Ethnicity and Place conference in Albuquerque, NM from November 5–7. Their panel was titled "Race, Gender, Slavery and Freedom in Everyday Life on the British coast of Central America, 1750-1830." Dr. Johnson and three students presented their papers: anthropology and feminist studies double major **Dina Gaxiola** '28 presented "The Case of Jane Trapp: Race, Gender, Slavery and Freedom in Early British Central America," psychology and sociology double major **Sophia Hernandez** '28 presented "From Enslavement to Influence: Gendered Agency, Racial Boundaries, and the Story of Ariadne Broaster," Dr. Johnson presented "Living across lines of freedom in the early history of Belize: The origins of

undergraduates presenting papers at this conference. The papers were well received, with one audience member sharing that this was the most interesting panel they had attended.

Assistant Professor of Feminist Studies **Meagan Solomon** published a peer-reviewed article, titled “Tejano Drag Kings: Reclaiming Space, Place, and Culture Through Performance,” in *WSQ: Women’s Studies Quarterly*, a top feminist studies journal. This article theorizes Tejano drag king performance as a critical source of resistance to state repression and cisheteronormative cultural standards. While drag kings in general, and Latino drag kings in particular, remain marginalized subjects in popular drag discourse, this article spotlights the work of Tejano drag kings and theorizes how their embodied performance and parody of masculinity serves as a vessel for feminist worldmaking. The article can be accessed [here](#).

Assistant Professor of Feminist Studies **Meagan Solomon**, alongside her Mellon Publicly-Engaged Humanities (PEH) Research Assistant **Mia Santoscoy** ’26, attended the 2025 Lesbian Lives conference in New York City from October 24–26. They presented on a roundtable titled “Latina/e Lesbian Archival Praxis and Memory Work: A Plática/Roda de Conversa with Malflora Collective,” which included seven members of the Latina/e lesbian collective co-founded by Dr. Solomon with support from the Mellon PEH grant. In the roundtable, Malflora Collective members discussed the non-traditional and community-based archival practices that Latina/e lesbians engage in, arguing that their memory work is rooted in collectivity, lived experience, and cultural reclamation as a form of decolonial praxis. Together, they highlighted how noninstitutional archives and digital memory projects like Malflora Collective are crucial for preserving the stories of marginalized communities and fostering transnational solidarity in the face of cultural and political oppression.

August 2025

Sociology and feminist studies graduate **Emily Dimiceli** '25 received an honorable mention for the prestigious Joe Feagin Undergraduate Paper Award for her fall 2025 sociology capstone project. This national award, presented by the Sociology of Racial and Ethnic Minorities section of the American Sociological Association (ASA), recognizes outstanding undergraduate scholarship. Emily accepted the honor at this year's ASA meeting in Chicago. In its commendation, the award committee described Emily's paper as "ambitious original research... well-grounded in racial theory, including conceptualizations of colorblind racism and historical racism."

May 2025

Sociology and feminist studies double major and race and ethnicity studies minor **Emily Dimiceli** '25 has been accepted into the 2025 American Sociological Association's (ASA) Honors Program. As a part of the program, she will present her capstone research paper, titled "'Obama was voted president by white people': Predictors of Americans' Perceptions of Racism," at this year's ASA annual meeting in Chicago, IL.

March 2025

On International Women's Day, Assistant Professor of Feminist Studies **Meagan Solomon** released the first episode of her collaborative podcast, *Malflora Podcast*, which is a series of pláticas (community conversations) with Latina/e lesbian activists, writers, artists, and scholars. *Malflora Podcast* is published by Malflora Collective, a community project dedicated to preserving the lives and legacies of Latina/e lesbians. Dr. Solomon first conceptualized Malflora Collective as a 2024 Mellon Publicly-Engaged Humanities Summer Fellow. Since then, the project has grown to include a team of nine members, including Communication Studies/ Latin American and Border Studies double major **Mia Santoscoy '26**, who is currently serving as Dr. Solomon's Research Assistant. In Episode 1 of *Malflora Podcast*, members from Malflora Collective introduce themselves and their work memorializing Latina/e lesbian history and culture. Listen here or on all major streaming platforms.

December 2024

centered on queer and lesbian Chicane literature, history, and activism. The virtual event was coordinated by the American LGBTQ+ Museum and can be viewed [here](#).

November 2024

Assistant Professor of Feminist Studies **Meagan Solomon** attended the National Women's Studies Association Conference in Detroit, MI, where she offered a presentation titled "Teaching to Transgress Imperialism, Settler Colonialism, and Zionism: The Feminist Studies Classroom as a 'Radical Space of Possibility' in Texas." She presented her work alongside Drs. Ruba Akkad of Austin College, Isis Nusair of Denison University, and Iveta Jusova of Carleton College on the panel, "Anti-Zionist Feminist Pedagogies: Teaching Toward Palestinian Liberation and an End to the Genocide in Gaza," which was well-attended by feminist faculty and students from around the world. Reflecting on her strategies and experiences teaching about Palestine within a feminist context since arriving at Southwestern in fall of 2023, Dr. Solomon's presentation concluded with a recording of SU alumna Brigit Reese's 2024 commencement speech on Gaza, which received a standing ovation from the audience.

August 2024

preserving Latina/e lesbian stories. In the workshop, she learned from a wide range of speakers who work in book, magazine, and multimedia publishing and helped produce Issue 7 of the online magazine, *PubLab*. As an art director for the magazine, she curated a portfolio of Anel I. Flores' paintings focused on lesbian intimacy, bodily autonomy, and queer liberation, which you can access [here](#).

July 2024

On June 23, Assistant Professor of Feminist Studies **Meagan Solomon** led a community teach-in at Alienated Majesty Books entitled "No Pride in Genocide: A Teach-In on Zionist Pinkwashing." The teach-in focused on defining and dismantling pinkwashing, or the process of promoting LGBTQ+ rights to appear progressive while simultaneously upholding oppressive systems that directly harm LGBTQ+ people, such as settler colonialism and occupation. The teach-in was part of a larger series of educational events in Austin focused on Palestinian liberation, which enabled a broader public to engage in critical dialogue informed by activist-oriented scholarship.

May 2024

paper, "Somos Lesbianas: Chicana Lesbian Place-Making and Place-Taking En Comunidad," which examines how Chicana lesbians take up art and writing as vessels for challenging oppressive forces and building coalition in the 1991 anthology "Chicana Lesbians: The Girls Our Mothers Warned Us About." edited by Carla Trujillo. In her paper, Solomon examines how Chicana lesbians integrate and redefine cultural customs in their creative expressions of self, spirituality, and familia that push back against the heteropatriarchal logics of Chicano nationalism. Underscoring the anthology form as a critical source of feminist coalition, she asserts that the voices featured in Chicana Lesbians intervene in dominant discourses on Chicana lesbian life toward a shared state of conocimiento - a spiritual and activist consciousness that tasks us with imagining and enacting new worlds.

February 2024

Assistant Professor of Feminist Studies **Meagan Solomon** participated in the Association for Jotería Arts, Activism, and Scholarship Conference in Los Angeles, CA, from February 15-18. With co-discussants X'andri and Alexandra Salazar, she presented on a roundtable entitled "The Pleasures and Intimacies of Jotería Spacemaking Within and Beyond the University." Their roundtable focused on the necessity of cultivating spaces to exist and commune as jotería (queer Latinxs) against continued assaults on our humanity. As politicians and their constituents continue to target and alienate LGBTQ+ folks, this roundtable asserted that jotería spacemaking is an act of survival.

Assistant Professor of Feminist Studies **Meagan Solomon** attended the American Studies Association Conference in Montreal last week, where she chaired and participated in a roundtable entitled “Community Knowledge and Solidarity Work as Public Scholarship and Collective Healing.” She presented her collaborative zine project with Ruba Akkad (TCU), situating zines and zinemaking as forms of community-accountable scholarship and healing.

October 2023

Assistant Professor of Feminist Studies **Meagan Solomon** published an essay entitled “Ana Castillo: A Multigenre Author” in the collection *Chicana Portraits: Critical Biographies of Twelve Chicana Writers*, edited by Dr. Norma E. Cantú and published by the University of Arizona Press. Dr. Solomon’s essay examines the central themes of feminist friendship, queer intimacy, and women’s spirituality in a selection of Ana Castillo’s essays and novels, including *Massacre of the Dreamers: Essays on Xicanisma* (1994), *The Mixquiahuala Letters* (1986), *Sapogonia* (1990), and *So Far From God* (1993). Released this month, you can find the collection [here](#).

September 2023

expands popular readings of Chicana lesbianism focused on sexuality by tending more deeply to the affective terrains of love and kinship represented in the 1991 anthology *Chicana Lesbians: The Girls Our Mothers Warned Us About*, edited by Carla Trujillo. Countering the (il)logics of white supremacy and Chicano nationalism, which reduce Chicana lesbians to symbols of sexual deviance, she argues that *Chicana Lesbian* embodies an expansive matrix of intimacies that reconstruct the Chicana lesbian figure from a one-dimensional symbol of sexual deviance to a multi-faceted figure who redefines what it means to love one's people and culture beyond colonial paradigms that privilege heterosexuality. The article can be read [here](#).

Feminist Studies faculty and students presented their research at the national Mujeres Activas en Letras y Cambio Social (MALCS) summer institute. This year's conference, "40 years of MALCS, Centuries of Activism: La Lucha Sigue for Racial, Reproductive and Decolonial Justice," took place on July 13-15, 2023, at UC Davis. Assistant Professor of Feminist Studies **Meagan Solomon** presented "Reflections on Chicana/Latina Lesbian Feminism from This Bridge to the Digital Dyke Age." Associate Professor of Feminist Studies **Brenda Sendejo**, MALCS chair and conference co-chair, presented on a roundtable titled "Chicana Movidas: Reflections on 50 years of Chicana Knowledge-Making" with her co-contributors to the *Chicana Movidas* anthology. The following students presented papers under the guidance of Sendejo: Myla Benally "Restoring the Meaning of Hózhó Within a Decolonial Framework: A Return to Balance and Beauty" and sof varnis "Weaving as a Decolonial Practice: Reconciliation, Transformation, and Spiritual Activism Among the Mampujan Weavers."

Associate Professor of Feminist Studies **Brenda Sendejo** was invited to participate as a faculty mentor in the Crossing Latinidades Humanities Research Initiative funded by the Andrew W. Mellon Foundation. Crossing Latinidades engages cross-institutional and cross-regional comparative research, training doctoral students, and new scholarship in emerging areas of inquiry about Latinos. The initiative serves as the anchor of the consortium of R1 Hispanic Serving Institutions at the University of Illinois at Chicago. Sendejo is among a group of Latino Studies faculty across the U.S. who will be paired with doctoral students through the professional mentorship program.

Southwestern's Feminist Studies Program was well represented at the annual meeting of WGS South last weekend. Elena Welsh '22 presented a paper entitled "Slow Pleasure/Slow Death: Rituals of Survival in Queer Media" as part of a panel on LGBTQ Health. Visiting Assistant Professor of Feminist Studies **Jordan Johnson** presented a paper entitled "Feminist Science Studies and Multispecies Justice: Responding to Weedy Entanglements" as part of a panel on Multispecies Feminisms.

December 2022

Associate Professor of Feminist Studies **Brenda Sendejo** and Assistant Professor of Communication Studies **Lamiyah Bahrainwala** attended the El Mundo Zurdo conference for

Bahrainwala presented “Pandemic lessons: Consent as anti-Racism,” and Sendejo presented “Movidias of Healing: The Spirit Work of Movement Era Chicanas.” The roundtable was well attended by lead scholars in the field of Anzaldúan Thought.

Associate Professor of Feminist Studies **Brenda Sendejo** attended the National Women’s Studies Association annual meeting in Minneapolis, Minnesota, from November 10-13. This year’s conference theme was “Killing Rage: Resistance on the Other Side of Freedom.” Sendejo presented a paper titled “The Spirit Work of bell hooks and Gloria Anzaldúa: Lessons on Radical Love as Resistance,” which drew from her book manuscript in progress.

November 2022

Visiting Assistant Professor of Feminist Studies **Jordan Johnson** published the article “Staying with the Trouble with Wilderness: Reworking Nature and Culture in the Plantationocene” in this fall’s issue of The Journal of Posthumanism. The issue is available [here](#).

Associate Professor of Feminist Studies **Brenda Sendejo** was invited to present her research as part of Mexic-Arte Museum's *Chicano/a Art Movimiento y Más en Austen, Tejas 1960s to 1980s* exhibit and lecture series. Her paper was titled "The Chicana Movement in Austin: A Legacy of Activism, Feminism, and Intergenerational Encuentros" and drew on themes from the exhibit that intersect with Sendejo's work on the Chicana/o movement and emergence of Chicana feminist thought in Texas. The lecture series and exhibit were supported by a grant from the National Endowment for the Humanities.

September 2022

Associate Professor of Feminist Studies **Brenda Sendejo** was elected chair of Mujeres Activas en Letras y Cambio Social (MALCS), a professional organization for self-identified Chicana, Latina, Native American/indígena mujeres and gender nonconforming academics, students, and activists. Sendejo cochaired the program committee for the MALCS 2022 Summer Institute, held July 27–30 in Fort Collins, Colorado. She also organized and served as a presenter on a roundtable about healing and re-membling as decolonial feminist praxis, informed by the work of Gloria Anzaldúa.

Visiting Assistant Professor of Feminist Studies **Jordan Johnson** '11 will receive a stipend to participate in the Bucknell Summer Institute this June.

January 2020

Mellon Postdoctoral Teaching Fellow in the Feminist Studies Program **Sequoia Maner**'s coedited book, *Revisiting the Elegy in the Black Lives Matter Era*, was published by Routledge Press. The title is available with a 20% discount from the publisher with the code HUM20 at checkout.
